

THE SHOP GUIDE

Who Investec serves, and what it sells

The target clients with real examples, what private banking actually does for them, what the investment bank sells, how the two connect, and the one thread that ties it all together. Explained with a shop analogy.

Prepared 7 October 2026 for the Investec UK Summer Internship 2027 application.
Built from Investec case studies, company announcements, law-firm and press releases. Every claim carries a tag and a source number.

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START HERE

The shop analogy

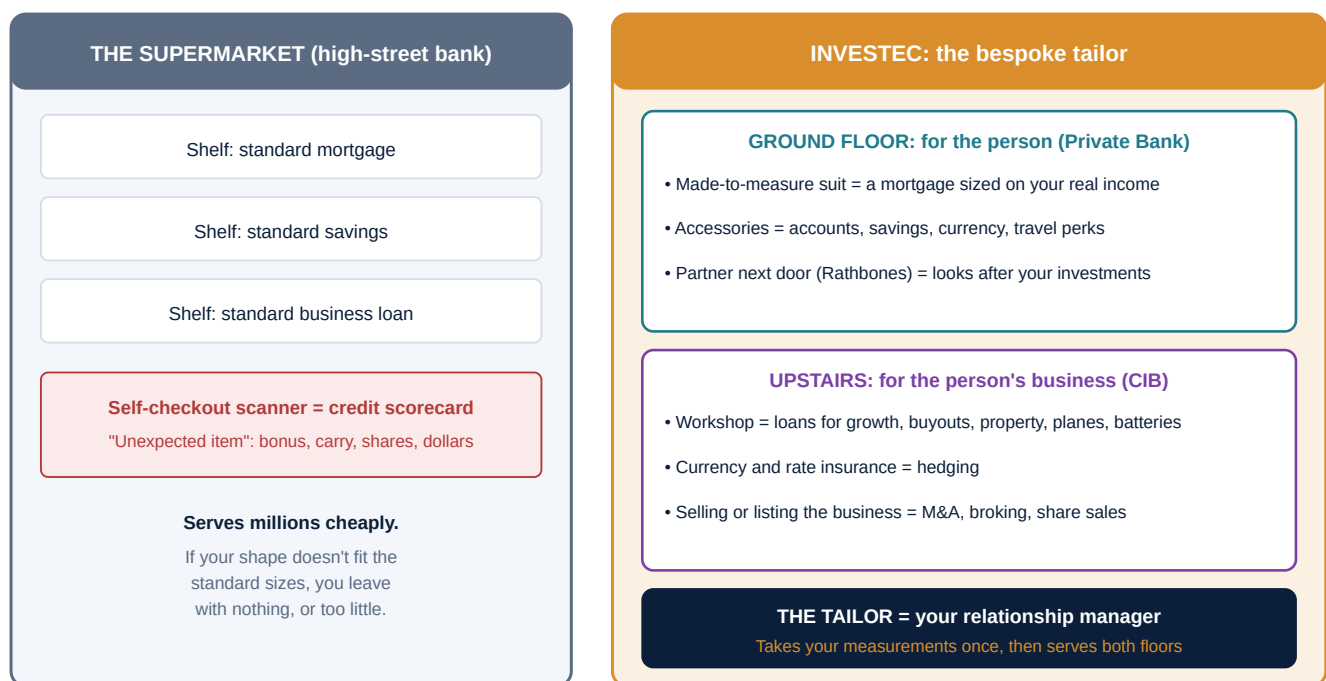
One picture that explains who Investec serves and what it sells.

Think of the big high-street banks as **supermarkets**. They sell standard products off the shelf, very cheaply, to millions of people. At the checkout a scanner, the **credit scorecard**, decides in seconds whether you get a loan. It works well for people with a normal salary.

Investec is a **bespoke tailor** in the same street. It serves people whose financial "body shape" does not fit standard sizes: pay that arrives as big bonuses, shares, a cut of a fund's profits, dividends from their own company, or dollars and euros. The scanner flags these as "unexpected items". The tailor measures them properly and makes something that fits.

The tailor's shop has **two floors**. On the ground floor it dresses the person (the **Private Bank**). Upstairs it equips the person's business (**Corporate and Investment Banking**, or CIB). The same tailor, the client's **relationship manager**, knows both, so a customer who comes in for one thing tends to stay for years and use both floors.

Figure 1 Investec as a bespoke tailor on a high street of supermarkets



Analogy by the author **Inferred**. Products and roles are from the sources cited in the following pages.

THE ANALOGY IN ONE BREATH

"High-street banks are supermarkets with a scanner at the checkout. Investec is a tailor for people whose income doesn't fit standard sizes, and it has a second floor for their businesses. The same banker serves both, so one mortgage can become a lifetime relationship."

PART 1

Who the target clients are

Not just "rich people". A very specific kind of rich person.

Investec's published entry bar for the UK Private Bank is roughly **£300,000 a year of income** and **over £3m of net worth**, for UK residents **Confirmed** [S8]. Mortgages usually start at **£1m** **Reported** [S9]. But the real filter is not size of wealth. It is **shape of income**. Investec's own client pages group them like this [R, search extracts] [S12, S13, S39]:

Client type	Why their money is "awkward"	What they typically need first
Private equity partners and fund managers	Salary plus bonus plus carried interest : a share of the fund's profits, paid years later and unpredictably. In Investec's survey, 43.5% said lenders struggle to understand their income Reported [S12]	A large mortgage that counts the carry
Hedge fund partners and owners	Partnership profit shares and bonuses that swing year to year Reported [S6]	A mortgage or a loan against property to fund their firm
Investment bankers, lawyers at US firms	Big bonuses, deferred shares (RSUs), pay in dollars Reported [S3, S5]	A high loan-to-value mortgage; currency planning
Founders and business owners	Wealth locked in their company; pay taken as dividends Reported [S1, S13]	Speed and a lender that values the business
Tech executives	Shares that vest over time; lump sums on leaving Reported [S5]	Currency hedging and investment advice
International families moving to the UK	Assets in foreign trusts and companies Reported [S9]	A UK mortgage that recognises overseas wealth
UK expats in Dubai or Switzerland	Live abroad, own UK property Reported [S16]	Buy-to-let mortgages from £1m

KEY TERM

Loan-to-value (LTV): the loan as a share of the property's value. A £3m home with a £2.7m loan is 90% LTV. Most lenders cap large loans well below that.

THE KEY FILTER

In 2018 the head of the UK Private Bank said: "We are not always especially useful to high net worth individuals who are simply looking to preserve their wealth" **Reported** [S36]. Investec wants people who are **making** money and will keep needing things, not people who just want to sit on it.

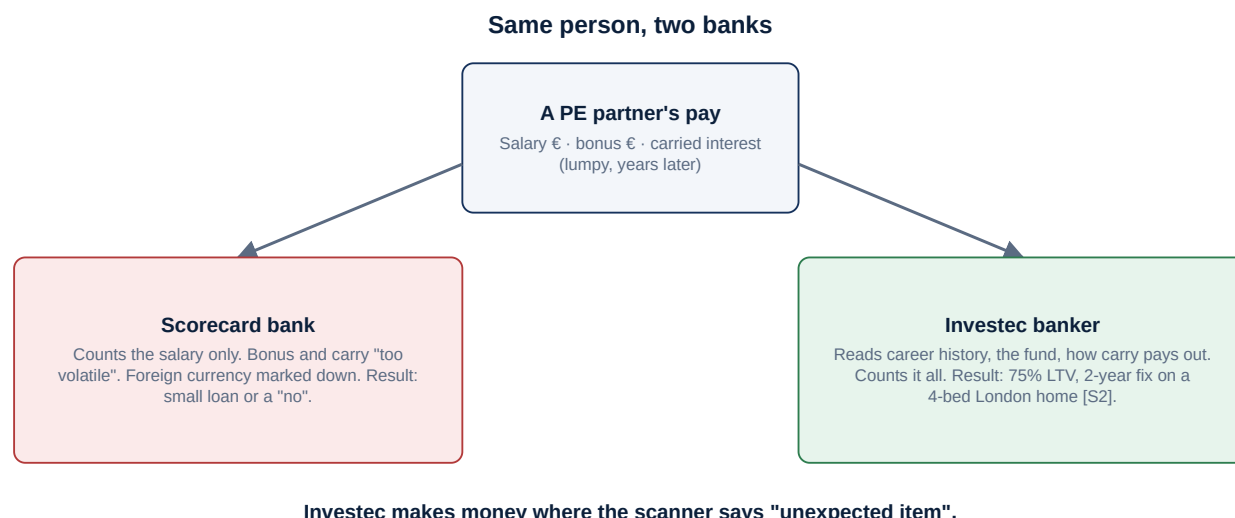
PART 2

What private banking actually means

Ground floor of the shop: the products, and what problem each one solves.

Private banking is not a mysterious service. At Investec it is mainly **lending**, with everyday banking and investment advice built around it. The single most important product is the **mortgage**: a loan secured on a home **Reported** [S9]. Everything else hangs off it.

Figure 2 Why the scanner says no and the tailor says yes



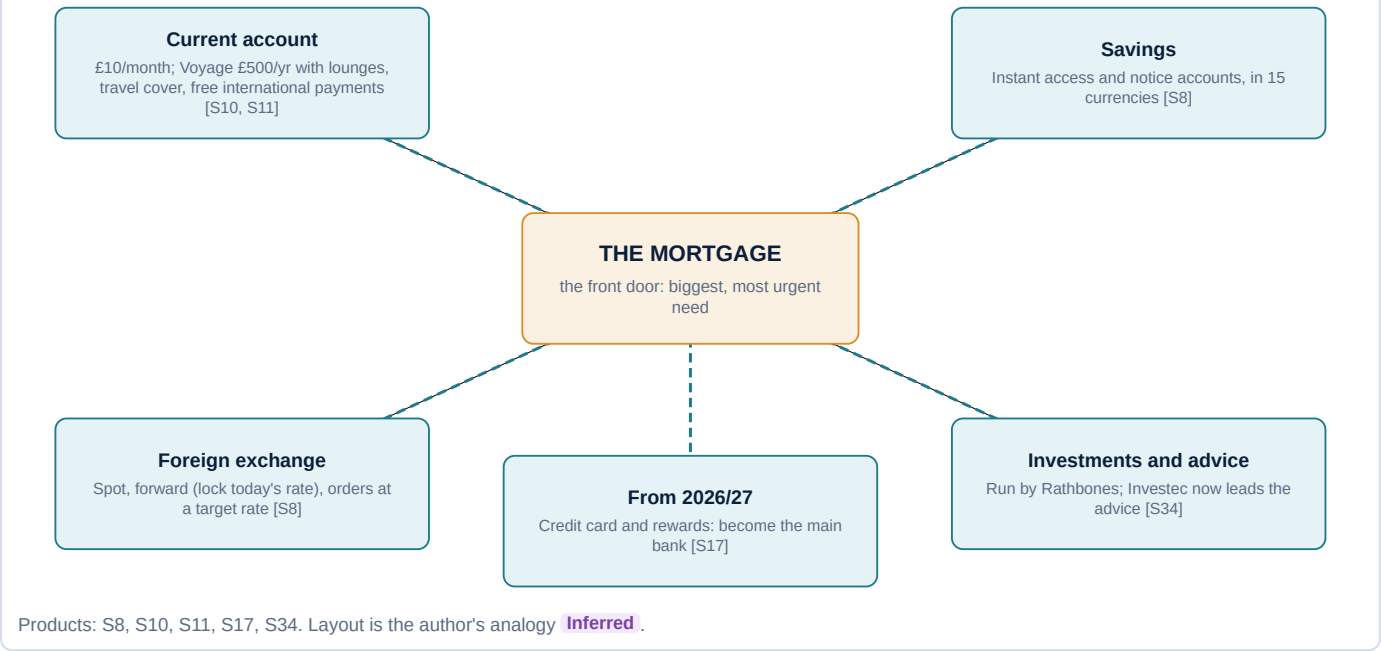
Example: Investec case study [S2] (search extract). Scorecard behaviour is a general description **Inferred**, supported by the broker statement that Investec does "not use standard credit scorecards" [S9].

The products, in plain English

Product	What it is	What it solves for the client
Large or complex mortgage	A home loan, usually from £1m, sometimes up to 90-95% LTV, counting bonuses, carry, shares, profit shares and foreign pay Reported [S9]	Buy the home they want now, not when the bonus lands
Interest-only with "capital reductions"	Pay only interest monthly; repay chunks of the loan when bonuses arrive Reported [S1, S3]	Matches lumpy income instead of fighting it
Revolving facility	A big overdraft secured on the home: draw, repay, redraw Reported [S9]	Cash on tap for opportunities or a business
Remortgage to release cash	A new loan on a home they own Reported [S6, S7]	Raise money for their business without selling shares
Bridging loan	Short-term loan to buy before selling the old home Reported [S9]	No missed house because of timing
Buy-to-let, including for expats	Loans on homes to rent out; expat version from £1m (May 2025) Reported [S16]	Grow a property portfolio
Portfolio loan	Borrow against investments managed by Rathbones, in £, \$ or € Reported [S8]	Cash without selling investments
Current accounts	Private Bank Account £10/month; Voyage £500/year with airport lounges, travel insurance, free international payments Reported [S10, S11]	Everyday banking that fits a global life
Savings	Instant access and 1- or 3-month notice, in 15 currencies Confirmed [S8]	Somewhere to park big bonuses and sale proceeds

Product	What it is	What it solves for the client
Foreign exchange	Spot, forward contracts to lock a rate, and orders that trigger at a target rate Confirmed [S8]	Protect dollar or euro pay from currency swings
Advice and investments	Run by Rathbones; Investec now leads the advice relationship [S34] Confirmed	Long-term wealth planning
Credit card and rewards (new)	Announced in the May 2026 plan Reported [S17]	Makes Investec the client's main bank

Figure 3 The mortgage is the front door; the other products are the rooms behind it



Five real (anonymised) Investec clients

All from Investec's own published case studies. investec.com blocks automated reading, so these were seen as search extracts Reported ; check the wording in a browser before quoting it word for word.

The shipping founder in a hurry	
Who	Co-founder, CEO and majority owner of a UK shipping company; wealth tied up in the company and an offshore trust.
Problem	Another lender could not complete in 3 weeks at the loan size he needed; his pay had just switched to dividends.
Investec did	£7.65m at 75% LTV, 10-year interest-only, with a planned paydown to 65% after 2 years. Money drawn 12 working days after first contact.
Why it fits	Speed plus understanding of a founder's company income.
Source	[S1]
The PE partner paid in euros	
Who	Private equity partner who had just joined a new firm; salary, discretionary bonus and carried interest, all in euros.
Problem	Variable, foreign-currency income; buying a 4-bed London family home.
Investec did	75% LTV, 2-year fixed, based on his career history and Investec's understanding of PE pay.
Why it fits	Carry is exactly the income scanners reject.
Source	[S2]

The couple paid partly in shares

Who	Married couple; bonus split into US dollar cash and RSUs (shares that vest over 2 years).
Problem	Irregular income.
Investec did	90% LTV from day one , 25-year interest-only, with paydowns when they choose.
Why it fits	Investec counts shares that have not yet vested.
Source	[S3]

The banker with no salary

Who	Ex-investment banker now investing in start-ups; net assets over £10m; no salary.
Problem	Wanted to fund 5 years of living costs until his investments pay out.
Investec did	5-year fixed, interest-only remortgage on a prime central London home.
Why it fits	Lends on wealth and future earnings, not on a payslip.
Source	[S4]

The tech executive with a dollar lump sum

Who	C-suite executive at a tech platform; Voyage and deposit client for years.
Problem	About to step away and receive a large US dollar payout.
Investec did	Banker set up currency hedging with Investec's dealers and brought in the wealth team to invest the money.
Why it fits	Best published example of one client moving from accounts to FX to investments.
Source	[S5]

PART 3

Why Investec chooses these clients

The business logic. Investec does not spell all of this out, so most of it is reasoning from the evidence.

Reason	How it makes money	Evidence
1. Less competition	The scanner banks say no or lend too little, so Investec competes with a handful of private banks, not the whole market. That supports better pricing Inferred	Investec does "not use standard credit scorecards" Reported [S9]
2. Good credit risk despite the "awkward" income	Clients are wealthy, loans are paid down from bonuses, and LTVs fall over time Inferred	Case studies with planned paydowns, e.g. 90% to 65% Reported [S6, S1]
3. One sale leads to many	A mortgage leads to deposits, FX on foreign pay, accounts and advice Inferred	RM adverts target "wallet share across lending, FX, investments, wealth management" Confirmed [S33]
4. Hard to leave	A banker who understands your carried interest is hard to replace Inferred	Long-standing client in the tech-executive story Reported [S5]
5. Cheap, stable funding	Wealthy clients leave large deposits, which fund Investec's lending Inferred	Strategy to become the "primary bank" Reported [S17, S37]
6. Tomorrow's business clients	Today's founder or PE partner brings their company or fund upstairs Inferred	Corporate RMs must partner "with Private Client teams when personal and business needs intersect" Confirmed [S32]

THE CATCH

The trade-off: tailoring is expensive. Investec's UK cost-to-income ratio is 54% **Confirmed** [S34], far above lean, computer-led lenders. The bet is that deeper, longer relationships pay for the extra people.

PART 4

Upstairs: what the investment bank side sells

Corporate and Investment Banking for mid-sized companies, funds and projects, with real named deals.

Upstairs the customer is a **business**, not a person. Investec focuses on the **mid-market**: established companies too big for small-business banking and too small for the global investment banks. It now aims to bank 1,000 of them by 2030, out of 60,000+ UK mid-sized firms **Reported** [S31].

Product	Plain English	Named example
Corporate broking and research	An ongoing retainer: the listed company's link to investors, advice on its share price, research, and running any share sale	Victrex plc appointed Investec joint corporate broker with J.P. Morgan, 18 Jun 2025 Confirmed [S18]. Investec was #1 UK small and mid-cap broker in Extel 2026 Confirmed [S38]
Equity capital markets (ECM)	Helping a company sell new shares to investors	Cohort plc (defence tech): £40m placing to buy EM Solutions, Investec sole bookrunner, 21 Nov 2024 Confirmed [S19]
M&A advice	Advising a buyer or seller on price, negotiation and takeover rules	N Brown (JD Williams, Simply Be): £191m take-private by founding-family member Joshua Alliance; Investec sole adviser to the bidder, agreed Oct 2024 Reported [S20, S21]. Treant plc : Investec co-advised the board through rival bids to a 305p offer, Apr 2026 Reported [S22]. TISE : sold to Miami International for £70.4m, 2025 Reported [S23]
Fund finance (Fund Solutions)	Short-term loans to private equity funds, secured on investors' promises to pay in	Goldenpeak Fund I : subscription line, Mar 2026 Confirmed [S24]. Over €10bn of fund finance in 12 months to May 2026 Reported [S25]
Energy and infrastructure	Long loans repaid from a project's own income	Fidra Energy, Thorpe Marsh : one of 13 lenders on £594m for the UK's largest battery project, Sep 2025 Confirmed [S26]. AMP Clean Energy : £360m, Investec sole lead arranger Reported [S27]
Real estate lending	Loans to property developers and investors	£922m lent in FY25/26, including £26m to Moorfield for 204-bed student housing in Bristol Reported [S28]
Aviation finance	Loans secured on aircraft, mostly to leasing companies	AELF : loan for an Airbus A330 leased to Hawaiian Airlines, its second deal with Investec Reported [S29]
Hedging (Treasury Risk Solutions)	Contracts that fix an exchange or interest rate in advance	Clients not named publicly; team expanded into Europe Aug 2024 Reported [S30]
Transactional banking (new)	Payments, cash management, day-to-day business accounts	Launched Nov 2025 for the mid-market build; no named clients yet Reported [S31]

THE COMMON THREAD

Why these products? Each one lets Investec sit close to an **owner or decision-maker** rather than a procurement department: the founder selling a company, the family taking a business private, the partners running a fund. Those are the same people the ground floor wants as private clients **Inferred** .

PART 5

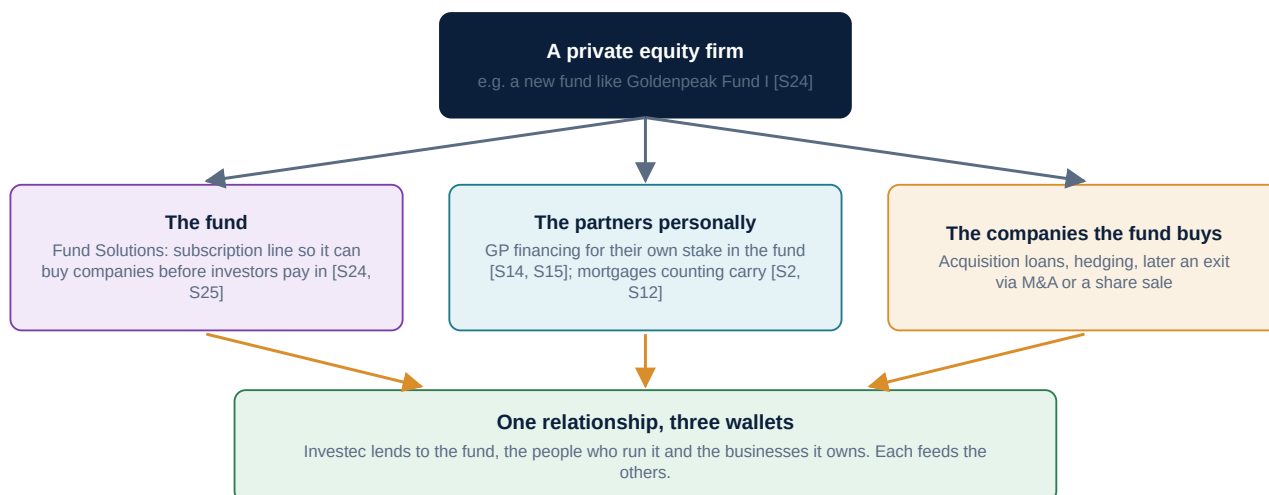
How the two floors connect

The investment bank and the private bank serve the same people at different moments.

Connection 1: the private equity ecosystem

Investec lends to private equity **funds** (Fund Solutions), to the **partners personally** for their own stake in the fund (GP financing) and with mortgages that count their carried interest, and to the **companies** those funds buy **Reported** [S12, S14, S24]. A dated but clear example: in 2011 Investec lent £14m to the managers of Clyde Blowers Capital so they could invest more of their own money in their £350m fund **Reported** [S15].

Figure 4 One private equity relationship, three wallets

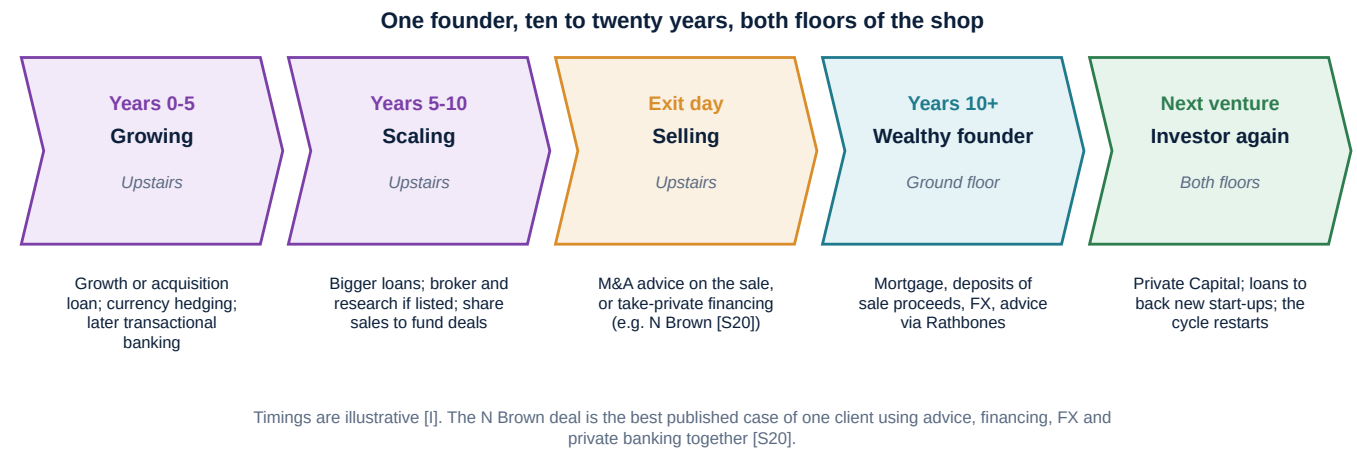


Sources as marked. Arrow logic is the author's **Inferred**.

Connection 2: the founder's life story

The best published example is **N Brown**. Investec says its M&A team worked "extensively with other teams from the bank, including Investec Private Capital, FX & Treasury solutions, and Private Banking" on Joshua Alliance's £191m take-private **Reported** [S20]. One family client got advice, financing, currency services and private banking from one bank.

Investec's job adverts make the link official: corporate relationship directors partner "with Private Client teams when personal and business needs intersect" **Confirmed** [S32]. Investec has published **no figures** on how many clients cross between the floors, so the scale of this is not proven **Inferred**.

Figure 5 A founder's journey through both floors

Illustrative timeline **Inferred**.

How long does a relationship last?

- **Corporate broking has no end date.** It is a retainer that runs for years and produces extra fees on each share sale or bid. Cohort shows one broking relationship producing a share sale and a takeover mandate in a single deal **Confirmed** [S19].
- **Lending repeats.** AELF came back for a second aircraft deal **Reported** [S29]. Fund managers return for each new fund (Inferred).
- **Mortgages run 5 to 25 years**, and many are interest-only with planned paydowns, so the banker stays in touch through each bonus round **Reported** [S1, S3, S4].
- **Investec holds most loans to maturity** rather than selling them on, "thereby developing a 'hands-on' and long-standing relationship" **Confirmed** [S35].
- No published figure for average client tenure exists.

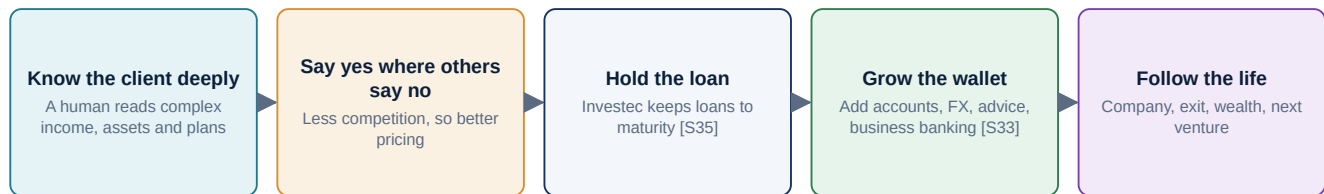
PART 6

What links the client to the product, and why

The single idea that ties the whole model together.

Across every product, the link is the same: **a person at Investec understands the client's situation better than a computer or a generalist would**, and that understanding is what lets Investec say yes, price the risk, and then offer the next thing.

Figure 6 The thread through the whole model



The thread through everything: one banker who understands the client better than a computer can

Synthesis **Inferred** of S9, S33, S35 and the examples above.

Why they do it this way

- **It is where the margin is.** Standard products are a price war. Complex clients pay for fit **Inferred**.
- **Their pay system rewards it.** Bonus pools come from profit after a charge for the capital used, not from sales volume, and loans are approved by committees needing unanimous consent **Confirmed** [S35]. That favours careful, repeat business with known clients.
- **It is a strategy, not an accident.** Investec says "We do not seek to be all things to all people" and focuses on "select market niches". Its 2026 plan pushes both floors further: a full private bank and a corporate bank that feels like private banking [C/R] [S34, S37].

SAY THIS IN AN INTERVIEW

"Investec targets people whose wealth is real but awkward, like PE partners paid in carry or founders paid in dividends. It wins them with a mortgage a scoring machine would refuse, then adds accounts, currency and advice. Upstairs it lends to and advises their funds and companies, from fund finance to M&A. One banker knows both sides, so a single loan can turn into a relationship that lasts the client's whole career."

What is not public

- Interest rates, maximum loan sizes and bridging terms.
- How many clients use both floors, and how long they stay.
- Named hedging or transactional-banking clients; a named 2023-26 IPO led by Investec.
- Exact dates on Investec's own case-study pages, which were seen only as search extracts.

BACK MATTER

Sources

All accessed 7 October 2026. **Confirmed** Confirmed in a primary document; **Reported** Reported or search extract; **Inferred** author's reasoning.

ID	Outlet	Title	Date	URL
S1	Investec case study (search extract)	A £7.65m mortgage in 12 business days	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/focus/intermediary-mortgages/case-study-a-7-65m-mortgage-in-12-business-days.html
S2	Investec case study (search extract)	Tailored mortgage for private equity partner with carried interest bonus income in euros	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/focus/prime-property/case-study-tailored-mortgage-for-private-equity-partner-with-carried-interest-bonus-income-in-euros.html
S3	Investec case study (search extract)	90% LTV with discretionary USD bonus and stock awards	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/focus/intermediary-mortgages/case-study-90-ltv-with-discretionary-usd-bonus-and-stock-awards.html
S4	Investec case study (search extract)	Remortgaging without an income	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/focus/intermediary-mortgages/case-study-remortgaging-without-an-income.html
S5	Investec client stories (search extract)	Client stories	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/individuals/bank-accounts/client-stories.html
S6	Investec case study (search extract)	High-value mortgage for hedge fund owner	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/focus/intermediary-mortgages/case-study-high-value-mortgage-for-hedge-fund-owner.html
S7	Investec case study (search extract)	A £12m remortgage across two homes for a technology entrepreneur	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/focus/intermediary-mortgages/case-study-a-12m-remortgage-across-two-homes-for-a-technology-entrepreneur.html
S8	Rathbones (Investec private banking page)	Private banking with Investec	fetch Oct 2026	https://www.rathbones.com/en-gb/wealth-management/private-banking-with-investec
S9	Money Helpdesk (broker guide)	Investec mortgages	18 Dec 2025	https://www.moneyhelpdesk.com/mortgages/mortgage-lenders/investec/
S10	Finder	Investec current accounts review	25 Jun 2025	https://www.finder.com/uk/current-accounts/investec-current-accounts-review
S11	Investec (search extract)	Voyage Account	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/individuals/bank-accounts/voyage-account.html
S12	Investec (search extract)	Who we work with: private equity professionals	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/individuals/bank-accounts/our-clients/private-equity-professionals.html
S13	Investec (search extract)	Who we work with: business owners	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/individuals/bank-accounts/our-clients/business-owners.html
S14	Investec (search extract)	GP financing	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/private-equity/fund-finance/gp-financing.html
S15	Financial Reporter	Investec provides £14m funding to management of Clyde Blowers Capital	10 Oct 2011	https://2025.financialreporter.co.uk/savings-and-investments/investec-provides-14m-funding-to-management-of-clyde-blowers-capital.html
S16	Mortgage Solutions	Investec launches bespoke BTL deal for expats	7 May 2025	https://www.mortgagesolutions.co.uk/news/2025/05/07/investec-launches-bespoke-btl-deal-for-expats/
S17	FSTech	Investec updates private client growth strategy to target UK wealthy	22 May 2026	https://www.fstech.co.uk/fst/Investec_updates_private_client_growth_strategy_to_target_UK_wealthy.php
S18	Victrex plc RNS (via ticker.app)	Appointment of Joint Corporate Broker	18 Jun 2025	https://www.ticker.app/lse/VCT/rns/2025-06-18/Appointment-of-Joint-Corporate-Broker/2681N
S19	Cohort plc RNS via Investegate	Proposed placing to raise £40 million	21 Nov 2024	https://www.investegate.co.uk/announcement/rns/cohort--chrt/proposed-placing-to-raise-40-million/8563368
S20	Investec deal page (search extract) / Morningstar	Takeover offer for N Brown Group plc; N Brown backs £191m buyout	Oct 2024	https://www.investec.com/advisory/deals/takeover-offer-for-n-brown-group-plc/
S21	Morningstar UK	N Brown backs £191 million buyout by founding family member	17 Oct 2024	https://www.morningstar.co.uk/uk/news/AN_1729163541995729800/n-brown-backs-gbp191-million-buyout-by-founding-family-member.aspx
S22	Trealt plc RNS via Investegate (search extract)	Recommended cash acquisition of Trealt plc	29 Apr 2026	https://www.investegate.co.uk/announcement/rns/trealt-tet/recommended-cash-acquisition-of-trealt-plc-/9542891
S23	Miami International Holdings	Offer to acquire The International Stock Exchange	Mar 2025	https://www.miaxglobal.com/news/miami-international-holdings-announces-offer-acquire-international-stock
S24	Walkers	Advising on Investec subscription line facility (Goldenpeak Fund I)	24 Mar 2026	https://www.walkersglobal.com/en/About-us/News/2026/03/Advising-on-Investec-subscription-line-facility

ID	Outlet	Title	Date	URL
S25	Alternative Credit Investor	Investec Fund Solutions surpasses €10bn fund finance loans in 12 months	11 May 2026	https://alternativecreditinvestor.com/2026/05/11/investec-fund-solutions-surpasses-e10bn-fund-finance-loans-in-12-months/
S26	National Wealth Fund	Fidra Energy reaches financial close on the UK's largest battery energy storage project	10 Sep 2025	https://www.nationalwealthfund.org.uk/news-and-publications/news/fidra-energy-reaches-financial-close-on-the-uks-largest-battery-energy-storage-project-backed-by-eig-and-the-national-wealth-fund/
S27	Investec press release (search extract)	Sole MLA and bookrunner on a £360m debt financing for AMP Clean Energy	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/welcome-to-investec/press/investec-acts-as-sole-mandated-lead-arranger-and-bookrunner-on-a-360m-debt-financing-for-amp-clean-energy.html
S28	Mortgage Solutions	Investec completes £922m in real estate lending	28 May 2026	https://www.mortgagesolutions.co.uk/specialist-lending/2026/05/28/investec-completes-922m-in-real-estate-lending/
S29	Investec press release (search extract)	Investec Aviation strengthens global AELF partnership	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_us/welcome-to-investec/press/investec-aviation-strengthens-global-aelf-partnership.html
S30	Treasury Today	Investec expands Treasury Risk Solutions business into Europe	Aug 2024	https://treasurytoday.com/insight-and-analysis/press-release-investec-expands-successful-treasury-risk-solutions-business-into-europe
S31	BusinessDay	Investec declares war in corporate mid-market	20 Nov 2025	https://www.businessday.co.za/companies/company-strategy/2025-11-20-investec-declares-war-in-corporate-midmarket
S32	Investec careers	Corporate Banking Relationship Director (13005)	2026	https://careers.investec.co.uk/jobs/vacancy/corporate-banking-relationship-director-13005/13023/description/
S33	Investec careers	Private Client Relationship Manager (13796)	2026	https://careers.investec.co.uk/jobs/vacancy/private-client-relationship-manager-13796/13814/description/
S34	Investec plc RNS via Investegate	Final Results 31/03/2026	21 May 2026	https://www.investegate.co.uk/announcement/rns/investec--invp/final-results-31-03-2026/9578809
S35	Investec	Pillar 3 disclosure report, March 2024	2024	https://www.investec.com/content/dam/investor-relations/financial-information/group-financial-results/2024/Investec-plc-group-and-Investec-Bank-plc-Pillar-3-disclosure-report-March-2024.pdf
S36	WealthBriefing	Targeting Restless Entrepreneurs: Investec's UK Private Bank	16 Oct 2018	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/Targeting-Restless-Entrepreneurs:-Investec's-UK-Private-Bank
S37	City AM	Investec eyes City hiring spree in major move into UK private banking	21 May 2026	https://www.cityam.com/investec-eyes-city-hiring-spreed-in-major-move-into-uk-private-banking/
S38	Extel	Investec retains the UK SMID crown	Jun 2026	https://www.extelinsights.com/results/uk-small-mid-cap-brokers/uk-small-mid-cap/2026/investec-retains-the-uk-smid-crown
S39	Investec (search extract)	What private banking support can Investec provide fund managers?	undated	https://www.investec.com/en_gb/focus/my-money/what-private-banking-support-can-investec-provide-fund-managers.html